

Kubernetes Basics: Pods, Services and Deployments Explained

Kubernetes can feel overwhelming with all its moving parts, but it simply automates how your apps run and talk to each other. Mastering these core building blocks is the exact first step to feeling confident in any Cloud role.

What you'll learn:

1. Pods: The Home of Your Container
2. Deployments: The Reliable Manager
3. Services: The Permanent Front Desk
4. Namespaces: Virtual Rooms

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1

TIP 1 OF 4

1. Pods: The Home of Your Container

Think of a Pod like a tiny apartment where your container lives. Usually, one Pod holds one container running your web app or database. Kubernetes creates and destroys Pods all the time, so you should never get attached to a specific Pod IP address. Instead, let Kubernetes manage them while you focus on the app code inside.

```
$kubectl run my-web-pod --image=nginx --port=80
```

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2

TIP 2 OF 4

2. Deployments: The Reliable Manager

Since Pods die easily, you rarely create them by hand. A Deployment is the helpful manager that watches your Pods 24/7. If a server dies and a Pod disappears, the Deployment immediately spins up a brand new one to replace it. It also lets you scale from 1 Pod to 10 Pods with a single command.

```
$kubectl create deployment my-app --image=nginx --replicas=3
```

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3

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3. Services: The Permanent Front Desk

Because Pods get new IP addresses every time they restart, users can never rely on a direct address. A Service acts as a permanent front desk or load balancer. It gives you a stable IP address and automatically routes incoming traffic to whichever healthy Pods are currently running.

```
$kubectl expose deployment my-app --port=80 --type=NodePort
```

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4

TIP 4 OF 4

4. Namespaces: Virtual Rooms

If your cluster is a big office building, Namespaces are the locked private rooms inside. They let multiple teams share the same Kubernetes cluster without stepping on each other's toes. You can have a 'dev' room, a 'staging' room, and a 'production' room completely isolated from one another.

```
$kubectl create namespace development
```

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Key Takeaways

- + Always use Deployments instead of raw Pods for production workloads.
- + Use `kubectl get all` to see a quick summary of everything running in your namespace.
- + Practice locally using Minikube or Kind before touching cloud clusters.
- + Add labels to your resources so you can easily filter and find them later.
- + Check pod logs immediately using `kubectl logs` when troubleshooting failed startups.

Watch Out For

- ! Hardcoding Pod IP addresses in your configuration files instead of using Services.
- ! Forgetting to set resource requests and limits, causing one runaway pod to crash the node.
- ! Trying to memorize complex YAML files instead of generating them with `kubectl` commands.
- ! Modifying production resources directly instead of updating your version-controlled manifests.

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